Spring-Green

Franchise Decision Report

Source: 2025 Franchise Disclosure Document

Filed with the Wisconsin Department of Financial Institutions

Legal entity: Spring-Green Lawn Care Corp.

Report generated: 2026-03-31

Franchise Decision Radar

Contents

1 Executive Summary

2 Decision Scorecard

3 Buyer-Fit Profile

4 Fee Burden Analysis

5 Item 19 Interpretation

6 Buyer-Side Economics Reality Check

7 Investment Breakdown

8 System Health

9 Risk Signals

10 Peer Context

11 Discovery Day Diligence Script

12 Source & Methodology

Spring-Green

Franchise Decision Report

Source: 2025 FDD filed with Wisconsin DFI · Filing year: 2025
Legal entity: Spring-Green Lawn Care Corp.
Report generated: 2026-03-31 · Franchise Decision Radar

Executive Summary

Spring-Green is a 48-year-old, privately held lawn care and tree/shrub treatment franchise with 126 outlets as of year-end 2024 — a mid-sized system that has been remarkably stable (+2, −2, +4 net units over three years). It occupies the middle ground of the lawn care cohort: lower fees than Lawn Doctor and NaturaLawn, better disclosure than Weed Man, and a balanced fee structure that does not punish low-revenue operators as severely as its higher-cost peers.

At $300K gross revenue, annual franchisor fees total $45,318 (15.1%) — second-lowest in the full cohort (only Weed Man is lower at 8.5%). The tiered royalty (10%/9%/8%) rewards revenue growth, and the 2% national advertising fund with no mandatory local advertising minimum gives franchisees more marketing autonomy than any peer. The Item 19 discloses 3 tables covering cost structure, revenue, and marketing effectiveness for 71 franchised businesses — with the unique addition of revenue-per-production-vehicle metrics and customer acquisition data.

The main limitations are scale and growth trajectory. At 126 units, Spring-Green is the second-smallest active cohort brand (behind NaturaLawn's 88). Net growth has been flat — the system is not expanding or contracting. For a buyer who values stability over growth momentum, this is neutral. For a buyer who wants to join a system with accelerating expansion, it is a constraint. Turnover is moderate (2.0%, 5.2%, 4.6%) with the 2023 and 2024 years reflecting a handful of exits from a small base.

Decision Scorecard

Quick-read assessment across key buyer decision dimensions. Ratings reflect this brand's position relative to the lawn care cohort.

DIMENSION	RATING	SUMMARY
Entry cost burden	**MIXED**	$118K–$134K total investment. Mid-cohort. Franchise fee ($27K–$45K) is substantially lower than Lawn Doctor ($124K) but higher than NaturaLawn ($20K–$40K).
Ongoing fee burden	**STRONG**	2nd lowest in full cohort: 15.1% at $300K. Only Weed Man (8.5%) is lower. No mandatory local advertising minimum — significant advantage over Lawn Doctor and NaturaLawn.
System stability	**MIXED**	Stable but flat: +2, –4, +2 net over 3 years. 126 units. Turnover moderate at 2–5%. No rapid growth, no contraction. Not exciting, but not concerning.
Revenue disclosure	**STRONG**	3-table Item 19 with cost structure, revenue by territory type, and marketing metrics. Average $744K single-territory, $1.55M multi-territory. Revenue per vehicle and customer acquisition data are unique.
Disclosure quality	**STRONG**	Clean filing, no litigation. Honest COGS definition (includes direct labor). Gross margin (68.1%) is more conservative and more useful than Lawn Doctor's materials-only 85.4%.
Downside risk profile	**MIXED**	Flat growth trajectory is the primary concern. System is not declining, but it is not demonstrating the kind of momentum that attracts new franchisees. Fee escalation risk is modest.
Buyer fit breadth	**STRONG**	Best balance of cost and data in the cohort. Works for first-time buyers, single-territory operators, and multi-unit operators. No mandatory local ad spend gives marketing flexibility.
Overall	**NOTABLE**	The most balanced option in the lawn cohort: moderate cost, solid disclosure, stable system, honest COGS. Not the cheapest (Weed Man), not the most transparent (Lawn Doctor), not the most stable (NaturaLawn) — but the best

DIMENSION	RATING	SUMMARY
		combination of all three. Relative cohort position does not establish absolute profitability.

OVERALL POSTURE

Spring-Green is the balanced choice in the lawn care cohort. It offers the second-lowest ongoing fee burden, the most useful gross margin disclosure (including labor in COGS), no mandatory local advertising minimum, and a clean litigation history. The trade-off is a flat growth trajectory and a mid-sized system (126 units) that lacks the scale of Lawn Doctor or the hyper-local niche identity of NaturaLawn. For a buyer who wants good data, manageable costs, and marketing autonomy — without paying Lawn Doctor's premium or accepting Weed Man's disclosure blackout — Spring-Green is the most natural fit.

Buyer-Fit Profile

Best fit for

- **First-time franchise buyer seeking a balanced entry:** Moderate investment ($118K–$134K), no mandatory local ad minimums, tiered royalty that rewards growth, clean disclosure. The lowest-friction entry in the cohort for a buyer who wants both data and manageable costs.
- **Operator who values marketing autonomy:** Spring-Green does not mandate a local advertising floor. The 2% national fund and optional regional fund (currently 0%) are the only marketing obligations. You control your own local marketing spend and strategy.
- **Single-territory operator targeting $500K+ revenue:** At $500K, the tiered royalty drops to an 8% marginal rate on revenue above $500K, and total fees are $67,318 (13.5%) — nearly half of NaturaLawn's $121,584 (24.3%) at the same revenue. The economics reward scale more than any other brand in the cohort.
- **Tree and shrub treatment interest:** Spring-Green franchises include a tree/shrub care line alongside core lawn services. This adds a revenue stream and seasonal diversification not available at all competitors.

Weaker fit for

- **Buyer seeking rapid system growth and momentum:** Net growth has been flat (+4 net over 3 years). If you value being part of an expanding system with accelerating franchisee additions, Spring-Green's trajectory may disappoint.

- **Buyer who wants franchisor-managed marketing:** The absence of a mandatory local ad program means you are responsible for your own marketing. If you prefer a turnkey marketing solution (like Lawn Doctor's mandatory program), Spring-Green's model requires more initiative.
- **Buyer in a market with no existing Spring-Green presence:** With 126 units, geographic coverage is thinner than Lawn Doctor's 653. You may be the only franchisee in your region, with limited peer support and less local brand recognition.

Proceed only if

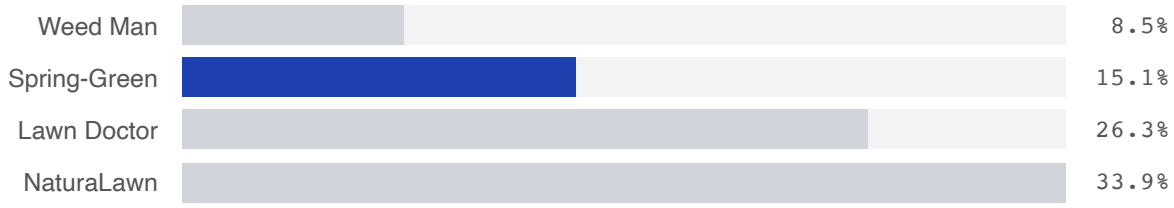
- You have modeled your territory using the single-territory median ($615K) rather than the all-business average ($1.09M), which includes multi-territory operators and inflates expectations.
- You have a local marketing plan and budget. Without mandatory franchisor marketing, customer acquisition is your responsibility. Table 3 shows the average franchisee spends 7.4% of revenue on marketing — build that into your financial model.
- You understand that the 68.1% gross margin includes direct labor (unlike Lawn Doctor's 85.4% which excludes it). Spring-Green's margin is more conservative but more realistic as a proxy for what you keep after direct costs.

Fee Burden Analysis

Spring-Green has the second-lowest ongoing fee burden in the lawn cohort — $45,318 (15.1%) at $300K revenue. Only Weed Man (8.5%) is lower. The primary advantage is the absence of a mandatory local advertising minimum: Lawn Doctor requires $30,000+ and NaturaLawn requires $60,000–$80,000, while Spring-Green's only marketing obligation is the 2% national fund ($6,000 at $300K). At $500K, Spring-Green's fees ($67,318, 13.5%) are less than half of NaturaLawn's ($121,584, 24.3%).

AT REVENUE	ROYALTY	MARKETING	TECH / OTHER	TOTAL	% OF REV	COHORT RANK
$200,000	$20,000	$4,000	$9,818	**$33,818**	16.9%	2/4
$300,000	$29,500	$6,000	$9,818	**$45,318**	15.1%	2/4
$400,000	$38,500	$8,000	$9,818	**$56,318**	14.1%	2/4
$500,000	$47,500	$10,000	$9,818	**$67,318**	13.5%	2/4

Cohort fee burden at $300K revenue



Total annual franchisor fees as a percentage of $300K gross revenue. Includes royalty, marketing, technology, and all mandatory recurring fees.

Component breakdown

- **Royalty (tiered: 10%/9%/8%):** 10% on first $250K of annual Gross Sales, 9% on $250K–$500K, 8% above $500K. First-season Industry Associate Program rates are lower (5%/4%/3%). Multi-territory discount: after 5,000 total customers, 8% on first $250K, 7% on $250K–$500K, 6% above $500K. Payable weekly. (pp. 16–17)
- **National advertising (2% of Gross Sales):** $6,000 at $300K. Simple and low. Regional advertising fund (up to 2% additional) is authorized but not currently imposed. If imposed, would apply only with approval of franchisees in the region. (pp. 17–18)
- **Technology ($235/month + per-user licenses):** $2,820/year base plus $192–$348/year per user (Office Online or Full Office License, minimum 1 Full Office License required). Total ~$3,168/year for a single-user setup. Subject to fee adjustment of up to 100% increase over any 5-year period — effectively a maximum doubling over 5 years. (pp. 17–18)
- **Call center ($500/month = $6,000/year):** National Call Center charges $500/month base during season (April–November), plus per-lead fees ($5/internet lead, $7.50/phone lead). Off-season rate is lower. This is a meaningful cost — at $300K revenue, the call center alone is 2% of gross. (p. 17)
- **Convention ($650/attendee):** Annual convention registration fee. Travel and lodging additional. (p. 17)

> **What this means:** At $300K revenue, Spring-Green's $45,318 in fees leaves $254,682 after franchisor costs — $33,482 more than Lawn Doctor ($221,200) and $76,266 more than NaturaLawn ($198,416). Over a 10-year term, that's $335K–$763K more retained earnings vs. peers. The fee advantage widens at higher revenue levels because the tiered royalty reduces the marginal rate.

> **NO MANDATORY LOCAL ADVERTISING FLOOR**
>
> Spring-Green is the only established brand in this cohort without a mandatory local advertising minimum. This is a structural advantage for operators who want to control their own marketing spend, but it is also a responsibility: Table 3 data shows the average franchisee spends 7.4% of revenue on marketing voluntarily. If you spend $0 on local marketing, you will likely underperform the disclosed averages.

Item 19 Interpretation

Spring-Green discloses a solid 3-table Item 19 covering cost structure, revenue, and marketing effectiveness. The disclosure is notable for including direct labor in the COGS calculation — making the 68.1% gross margin more conservative and more useful than Lawn Doctor's materials-only 85.4%. (pp. 47–50)

Cost structure (Table 1, 2024)

62 franchised businesses with $300K+ in Gross Sales:

- **Material costs:** Average 12.8%, median 12.6%.
- **Direct labor costs:** Average 19.1%, median 18.2%.
- **Total cost of sales:** Average 31.9%, median 30.8%.
- **Gross profit margin:** Average 68.1%, median 69.2%.
  This is the most useful cost disclosure in the lawn cohort because it separates materials from labor and includes both in COGS. At 68.1% margin after materials AND labor, the franchisee retains substantially more than the raw percentage might suggest when compared to Lawn Doctor's 85.4% (which excludes labor entirely).

Revenue (Table 2, 2024)

71 franchised businesses operating 2+ years:

- **All businesses (71):** Average $1,093,544, median $886,680. Range: $168K–$3.87M.
- **Single territory (36):** Average $743,598, median $614,679. Range: $168K–$1.75M.
- **Multiple territories (32):** Average $1,554,728, median $1,321,291.
- **Revenue per customer:** Average $556, median $549. Range: $393–$957.
- **Revenue per production vehicle:** Average $201,144, median $203,395.

Marketing effectiveness (Table 3, 2024)

- **Marketing investment:** Average 7.4% of revenue (median 7.9%). Range: 2.0%–20.6%.
- **New service agreements per $1 of marketing:** Average 0.0042, median 0.0029. (At $50K marketing spend, this implies ~210 new agreements for the average operator.)
- **Revenue per new agreement:** Average $424, median $399.

What's missing

- **Owner income or net profit:** The 68.1% gross margin is after materials and labor, but before overhead (vehicle, insurance, office, franchisor fees). No net income data is disclosed.
- **Geographic or seasonal variation:** Revenue and cost data are system-wide averages — no breakdown by region or season length.
- **Customer retention rate:** Revenue per customer ($556) is disclosed but annual retention/churn rates are not.

From gross revenue to owner economics

Spring-Green's Item 19 provides both revenue and COGS (including labor), making triangulation more straightforward than Lawn Doctor:

For a median single-territory operator ($615K revenue):

- COGS at 31.9% (materials + labor): ~$196K
- Gross margin (68.1%): ~$419K
- Franchisor fees (interpolated from model): ~$57K
- Voluntary marketing at 7.4% (system average): ~$46K
- Overhead (vehicle, insurance, office): $25K–$40K
- Implied pre-tax owner income: $276K–$291K

For a conservative single-territory ($400K revenue):

- COGS at 31.9%: ~$128K
- Gross margin: ~$272K
- Franchisor fees: ~$47K
- Marketing at 7.4%: ~$30K
- Overhead: $25K–$35K
- Implied pre-tax owner income: $160K–$170K

> **What this means:** Spring-Green's economics triangulate more favorably than Lawn Doctor's at equivalent single-territory revenue, primarily because of lower franchisor fees. At the median ($615K), a Spring-Green operator potentially retains $276K–$291K vs. an estimated $198K–$258K

> at Lawn Doctor — a $20K–$90K annual advantage. The difference is almost entirely fee structure, not operating economics. But note: Spring-Green's voluntary marketing spend (7.4%) should be treated as quasi-mandatory — operators who spend less likely underperform the disclosed averages.

Buyer-Side Economics Reality Check

Important framing: This is not a profitability forecast. It is an illustrative scenario exercise using Spring-Green's disclosed Item 19 revenue and cost-of-sales data. COGS (31.9% average) includes materials AND direct labor — a more complete cost picture than some peers. 'Remaining' must still cover vehicle costs, insurance, office overhead, voluntary marketing spend (average 7.4% of revenue), owner draw, and taxes. Your actual results depend on territory, labor market, season length, customer density, and execution.

SCENARIO	REVENUE	FRANCHISOR FEES	EST. COGS	REMAINING
Conservative single-territory	$400,000	$56,318 (14.1%)	$127,600	**$216,082**
Median single-territory	$615,000	$67,318 (10.9%)	$196,185	**$351,497**
Average multi-territory	$1,555,000	$67,318 (4.3%)	$496,045	**$991,637**

Revenue from Item 19 Table 2 (2024, businesses operating 2+ years). COGS at 31.9% (Table 1 average for businesses with $300K+ Gross Sales, includes materials and direct labor). 'Remaining' covers overhead, voluntary marketing, owner draw, and taxes. Industry Associate first-season royalty rates (5%/4%/3%) not modeled — these apply only to first-season operators.

Investment Breakdown

Mid-cohort entry cost: $117,543–$134,342 total. The franchise fee ($27,000–$45,000) varies by territory population and is substantially lower than Lawn Doctor's $124K bundled package. A typical new single-territory franchise pays $35,000 ($27,000 license + $8,000 territory fee). Additional territories can be acquired at incremental territory fees.

CATEGORY	LOW	HIGH
Initial Franchise Fee	$45,000	$45,000
Production Vehicles, Equipment and Fixtures	$5,519	$5,519
Technology Equipment and Software	$3,450	$3,850
Opening Inventory and Supplies	$2,543	$2,543
Initial Marketing Campaign Fee	$35,000	$35,000
Initial Property Data Fee	$16,500	$16,500
Training Expenses	$0	$1,835
Miscellaneous Opening Costs	$1,550	$13,168
Additional Funds - 3 Months	$7,981	$10,927
Total	**$117,543**	**$134,342**

Key line items

- **Franchise fee ($27,000–$45,000):** Base license ($27,000) plus territory fee based on population. Multi-unit discounts available. (p. 14)
- **Vehicle ($15,000–$25,000):** Truck or van for equipment transport. Can start with existing vehicle if suitable.
- **Equipment ($20,000–$28,000):** Spray equipment, spreaders, and supplies. Purchased from approved vendors.
- **Working capital ($15,000–$20,000):** First 3–6 months of operations.
- **Technology setup ($3,000–$5,000):** Computer, software licenses, phone system.

> **What this means:** Spring-Green's $118K–$134K total is $30K–$40K less than Lawn Doctor and comparable to NaturaLawn's mid-range. The franchise fee is the key differentiator: Spring-Green's $27K–$45K vs. Lawn Doctor's $124K means substantially more of your investment goes into working capital and equipment rather than upfront fees.

System Health

Stable and unremarkable — which is not a criticism. Spring-Green's 126-unit system has been essentially flat for three years: +2, −4, +2 net. Turnover is moderate (2.0%, 5.2%, 4.6%). For a 48-year-old system, this suggests maturity rather than decline — the brand is holding its position without aggressive expansion or concerning contraction.

YEAR	OPENED	CLOSED	NET	END COUNT
2022	2	0	+2	128
2023	2	4	−4	124
2024	4	0	+2	126

Outlet trajectory

- **2022:** 126→128 (+2 net). 2 opened, 0 closed. 3 transfers. Turnover 2.0%.
- **2023:** 128→124 (−4 net). 2 opened, 4 closed, 2 non-renewals. 2 transfers. Turnover 5.2%.
- **2024:** 124→126 (+2 net). 4 opened, 0 closed. 5 transfers. Turnover 4.6%.

Context on size

At 126 units, small absolute numbers can create large percentage swings. The 5.2% turnover in 2023 represents just 8 exits from a 128-unit base — hardly a systemic problem. The 5 transfers in 2024 suggest a healthy resale market proportional to system size.

> **What this means:** Spring-Green is a mature, stable system. It is not growing rapidly, which may concern buyers seeking expansion momentum. But it is also not contracting, which is the more important signal for franchise durability. A buyer joining Spring-Green is joining a system that has proven it can sustain itself at this size for decades.

Risk Signals

Litigation

No litigation required to be disclosed (Item 3). No bankruptcy (Item 4). Clean legal history across the system's 48-year franchise history.

Entity and ownership

Spring-Green Enterprises, Inc. — privately held. The company also operates Spring-Green's tree and shrub care services as part of the franchise offering. The private ownership provides operational stability without the leveraged acquisition dynamics that can accompany PE buyouts.

Fee escalation risk

The regional advertising fund (up to 2%) is not currently active and requires franchisee approval in the region to implement. Technology fees can increase up to 100% over any 5-year period — the most explicitly defined escalation cap in the cohort. The call center fee ($500/month + per-lead fees) is season-dependent, which creates cost variability but also means you pay less in the off-season. (pp. 17–18)

System growth concern

Flat growth is not a crisis, but it is worth investigating. A system that adds 2–4 net units per year in a growing market may be failing to attract new franchisees — or it may be deliberately maintaining quality over growth. Ask the franchisor which it is, and why.

Peer Context

Spring-Green occupies the center of the lawn care cohort on most dimensions: moderate cost, solid disclosure, stable system, honest COGS definition. It is the best-balanced option for a buyer who does not want to pay Lawn Doctor's premium, does not want Weed Man's disclosure blackout, and does not want NaturaLawn's paradoxically high fee burden despite a low headline royalty.

Key comparison: Lawn Doctor. Lawn Doctor offers more data (4 tables vs. 3), a larger system (653 vs. 126 units), and lower turnover. But it costs $33,500/year more in fees at $300K revenue and $55,000/year more at $500K. Over 10 years, that gap is $335K–$550K. Spring-Green's 68.1% gross margin (including labor) is also more useful for financial modeling than Lawn Doctor's 85.4% (materials only).

Key comparison: NaturaLawn. NaturaLawn has the lowest entry cost and highest revenue per customer ($810 vs. $556), but its ongoing fee burden is the highest in the cohort — $101,584 at $300K vs. Spring-Green's $45,318. NaturaLawn's $60K–$80K mandatory marketing spend

dominates the fee structure. A buyer choosing NaturaLawn over Spring-Green is paying 2.25× the ongoing fees for a niche organic positioning — which may or may not justify the premium.

Key comparison: Weed Man. Weed Man's 8.5% total fee burden is the lowest by far, but Weed Man discloses zero Item 19 data. A buyer choosing Weed Man over Spring-Green saves $20K/year in fees but loses all revenue benchmarks, margin data, and customer metrics. For a buyer with independent market knowledge, this trade-off might work. For a first-time buyer, it is risky.

METRIC	LAWN DOCTOR	NATURALAWN	SPRING-GREEN	WEED MAN
System size	653	88	126	121
Investment range	$150K–$177K	$77K–$152K	$117K–$134K	$81K–$109K
Fee burden at $300K	$78,800	$101,584	$45,318	$25,550
% of revenue	26.3%	33.9%	15.1%	8.5%
3-year net growth	+40	+6	+4	+27
Recent attrition	0.2%	2.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Royalty rate	10.0%	9.0%	varies	varies

Decision overlay

Lowest ongoing fee burden (with Item 19)	Spring-Green — 15.1% at $300K. Weed Man is cheaper but has no Item 19.
Marketing autonomy	Spring-Green — No mandatory local advertising minimum. You control your own marketing budget.
Most useful gross margin data	Spring-Green — 68.1% margin includes direct labor — more realistic than Lawn Doctor's materials-only 85.4%.
Largest system	Lawn Doctor — 653 units vs. Spring-Green's 156. Scale has operational advantages.

Highest revenue per customer	NaturaLawn — $810/customer vs. Spring-Green's $556. Organic positioning commands premium pricing.
Budget-conscious buyer	Weed Man or Spring-Green — Weed Man: lowest fees, no data. Spring-Green: moderate fees, solid data. Depends on your risk tolerance.

Discovery Day Diligence Script

These questions are derived from specific findings in the Spring-Green 2025 FDD. Each includes context on why it matters and what to listen for.

1. The system has been essentially flat for 3 years (+2, −2, +4 net). Is this intentional, and what is the growth strategy going forward?

A 48-year-old system that adds 2–4 net units per year may be in maintenance mode. You want to know if the franchisor is investing in growth or managing a mature portfolio.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They articulate a specific growth plan — target markets, recruitment strategy, conversion franchise program. Honest about historical growth pace and reasons.

FOLLOW-UP

How many franchise inquiries do you receive per year, and what is the close rate?

2. Table 1 shows 68.1% average gross margin including labor. What is the typical labor cost breakdown — seasonal vs. year-round employees, and how many technicians for a single-territory operation?

Labor at 19.1% of revenue is the largest single cost. Understanding labor structure is critical for your financial model.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They provide benchmarks: typical crew size, seasonal vs. year-round ratio, labor cost per production vehicle. Even better if they share data on labor markets by region.

FOLLOW-UP

What is the average revenue per employee for a single-territory operation?

3. Revenue per customer averages $556 with a median of $549. How many customers does a median single-territory operator serve, and what is annual customer retention?

At $615K median revenue and $549 median revenue per customer, a single-territory operator serves roughly 1,120 customers. You need to know the churn rate to model acquisition costs.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They provide customer counts by territory size and annual retention rates. The data should be consistent with the revenue and revenue-per-customer figures.

FOLLOW-UP

What is the typical cost to acquire a new customer, and how does it compare to the Table 3 marketing effectiveness data?

---

4. The franchise fee ranges from $27K to $45K based on territory population. How is territory size determined, and can I see examples of territory maps?

Territory design directly affects revenue potential. Understanding the methodology helps you evaluate whether your specific territory can support the revenue benchmarks in Item 19.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They explain the population-based methodology, show example territories, and discuss how territory size correlates with revenue in the Item 19 data.

FOLLOW-UP

What is the average population per territory for the 36 single-territory operators in Table 2?

---

5. The regional advertising fund (up to 2% additional) requires franchisee approval. Has this ever been proposed or implemented in any region?

If activated, this would increase the marketing cost by $6,000–$10,000/year at $300K–$500K revenue.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

Clear history of whether the fund has been proposed, voted on, or implemented in any region. Honest about the approval process.

FOLLOW-UP

What voting threshold is required, and how are regions defined?

---

6. The technology fee has a cap of 100% increase over any 5-year period. What has been the historical pattern of technology fee increases?

A $235/month fee that can double to $470/month over 5 years is a meaningful escalation. You want to know the actual historical trajectory.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They provide the history of technology fee changes and explain what service improvements accompanied each increase.

FOLLOW-UP

Are there additional technology costs beyond the base fee and user licenses that I should budget for?

---

7. Table 3 shows marketing effectiveness data — 0.0042 new agreements per $1 of marketing spend. How does this compare to your internal benchmarks, and what marketing channels drive the most agreements?

Unique disclosure. You want to understand whether the average marketing ROI is achievable in your market.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They discuss which channels (direct mail, digital, door-to-door) are most effective and provide regional variation data.

FOLLOW-UP

What is the recommended marketing mix for a new single-territory operator in a suburban market?

---

8. Revenue per production vehicle averages $201K. How many vehicles does a typical single-territory operator run, and is there a minimum?

At $615K median single-territory revenue, this implies roughly 3 vehicles per territory. Vehicle count directly affects labor costs and capital requirements.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

They explain the relationship between territory size, vehicle count, and revenue. Provide benchmarks for new vs. mature territories.

FOLLOW-UP

What is the average cost per production vehicle including equipment and insurance?

Source & Methodology

Source document: Spring-Green 2025 Franchise Disclosure Document, filed with the Wisconsin Department of Financial Institutions. 263-page regulator-source PDF. SHA-256: `a3b30d7521fe546489e6dd90b28030ff81f242c9db9743b693c5296cc8638f97`

Extraction: Structured data extraction using pdfplumber with manual review. Field-level provenance recorded (source year, state, page number, item reference). Extraction confidence: high (3+ fields spot-checked against source).

Fee modeling: Year 5 assumptions, single territory, 1 owner + 1 technician. Revenue distributed evenly across the year. All mandatory fees enforced. See fee_modeling_framework.md for full methodology.

Economics scenarios: Revenue estimates drawn from Item 19 data. COGS ratio is brand-specific (derived from available company-owned P&L data; see Economics section for derivation and assumptions). Scenarios are illustrative, not predictive. Operating costs beyond franchisor fees and COGS are not estimated — the buyer must validate these independently.

Peer comparison: Same methodology applied to all 4 brands in this cohort (Lawn Doctor, NaturaLawn, Spring-Green, Weed Man). All from 2025 FDDs filed with Wisconsin DFI.

Disclaimer: This report is not legal advice, investment advice, or a recommendation to buy or avoid this franchise. It is a structured analysis of publicly available regulatory filings. The buyer should read the actual FDD, consult a franchise attorney, and conduct their own due diligence before making any investment decision. Economics scenarios are illustrative frameworks for buyer-side thinking — not profitability forecasts.